

Launch Playbook

Everything you need to ship Galaxy Defender this weekend.
Read on your phone in ~15 minutes.

What's inside

- **Section 1** — Why we're NOT adding streaks & XP
- **Section 2** — Final walk-through: what's solid, what to fix, what to skip
- **Section 3** — Selling on Gumroad + 5 alternatives compared
- **Section 4** — Marketing from your phone (pricing → first sales)
- **Section 5** — Legal pages: what's compulsory in the UK
- **Section 6** — The weekend launch punch list

■ **How to use this doc:** work through it top-to-bottom, ticking each box. Most of it can be done from your phone. Total time: ~2 hours focused work to be live.

1. ■ On Streaks & XP Badges

My take: skip them.

For a one-purchase self-paced course aimed at parents-buying-for-kids, streaks and XP usually backfire:

- **Streaks create guilt, not joy** — "you broke your 5-day streak!" works for daily-habit apps (Duolingo), terrible for project-based learning where a kid takes a week off and comes back to a punishing red X.
- **XP without competition is meaningless** — XP works when kids compare with peers. In a solo home setting, XP is just a number going up that you have to maintain.
- **You already have the right reward stack:** green ticks on the roadmap, a visibly growing game each lesson, the Showcase + Capstone "I made this" moment, and a printable named certificate.

That's the right stack for a "real skills" course. Adding XP/streaks would push it toward feeling like a casual game and undercut your *"real coding skills for life"* positioning.

If you ever launch a cohort/classroom version, add a leaderboard (cohort-only, not global) so kids in the same group can high-five each other. Until then, keep it clean.

2. ■ Final Walk-Through

■ Course content — done, excellent

11 lessons + capstone, 13 PDF handouts, sprites, sound, certificate, 70+ mini-games, parent guide. **No content gaps.**

■■ Missing — should fix before going live

- 1 **Legal pages** — yes, compulsory in the UK (see Section 5). Not optional.
- 2 **The gameplay demo video** — your single highest-converting marketing asset. You're recording it; just do it.
- 3 **A favicon** — the little icon in browser tabs. Right now the tab shows a blank icon. Add a favicon.ico + one `<link rel="icon">` line in each HTML file.
- 4 **Social-share preview image** — when someone shares your link on WhatsApp/Facebook, no preview shows. Add `<meta property="og:image">` pointing to a 1200x630 PNG.
- 5 **Mobile check** — open the landing page on your phone before launch. The grid of "Everything inside" cards may look squished.

■ Nice-to-have (post-launch only, if revenue justifies)

- A real demo GIF (not just a Trinket embed)
- Mailing list signup for "send me free Lessons 0+1"
- Affiliate program (10% commission for parents who refer friends)
- A "wall of student games" social-proof page
- Sales analytics (Plausible.io is £9/mo, GDPR-friendly)

■ Skip entirely

- Streaks / XP (covered in Section 1)
- A real-time chat widget (one-person business, you'd burn out)
- A native mobile-app version
- Translations (later, once you have UK base)

3. ■ Selling on Gumroad (and alternatives)

Gumroad (your existing account)

Fees (as of 2026): Flat **10%** of each sale, no monthly fee. Gumroad handles EU/UK VAT on digital products for you.

Setup steps:

- 1 Gumroad dashboard → **Products** → New product → **Digital product**
- 2 Title: *"Galaxy Defender — NextGen Coders Lab"*
- 3 In the **Content / After Purchase** message, paste your live Vercel URL + the course password. (Don't upload the course files — host them on Vercel and let the password gate handle access.)
- 4 Price: **£15–35** (covered in Section 4)
- 5 Cover image: a screenshot of the game OR your Big Picture infographic
- 6 Description: short paragraph + 6-bullet feature list + 1-sentence guarantee
- 7 Click **Publish** → Gumroad gives you a public URL (e.g. gumroad.com//galaxydefender)
- 8 Paste that URL into your landing page's "Get full access" button (replace the placeholder).

One critical detail: Gumroad doesn't auto-generate unique passwords per customer. Everyone gets the same one. If it leaks, change it on Vercel + update the Gumroad post-purchase message. For a kids' course at this price point, that's fine.

Alternatives (and their cuts)

Platform	Fee	Best for
Gumroad	10% flat	Solo creators, starting out — what you have
Lemon Squeezy	5% + \$0.50/sale	Same niche, slightly cheaper at scale
Stripe Payment Link	2.9% + 30¢	Lowest fees; you handle VAT + post-purchase yourself
Payhip	5% flat	UK/EU-friendly, simple
Podia	\$33/mo + 0%	Once you have 50+ sales/month — built-in course player
Teachable	\$39/mo + 0%	Multi-course brand — overkill for one course

My recommendation: start with Gumroad (you have it, it works). Migrate to Lemon Squeezy once monthly sales pass £200 — the 5% beats Gumroad's 10% from that point. Don't touch Podia/Teachable until you have a clear multi-course brand.

4. ■ Marketing from Your Phone

Step 1 — Price the course (decide today)

- **£15 / \$19** — easy yes, no parent thinks twice. Best for fast volume.
- **£25 / \$29** — "premium but accessible," matches CodaKid's monthly. **Recommended.**
- **£39 / \$49** — works if you have testimonials and a polished sales video; risky cold.

Launch trick: start at £19 ("launch price") for the first 2 weeks, then move to £25. Creates urgency without lying.

Step 2 — Record the demo (15 minutes today)

On your laptop, run `galaxy_defender_showcase.py`. Open Win+G (Game Bar) → start recording. Play for 25 seconds: menu → 4-way dodge → shoot → win. End recording. You now have an MP4 with sound.

Step 3 — Cut three versions on your phone (CapCut)

- 1 **15-second TikTok / Reels / YouTube Shorts** — gameplay only, big caption: *"My 10-year-old built this in Python this weekend ■"*
- 2 **30-second Instagram / Facebook post** — gameplay + slow text overlay: *"What's inside the course → 11 lessons → 70+ mini-games → 7-day capstone"*
- 3 **60-second YouTube / landing page video** — same gameplay + your voiceover (record on phone): *"Hi, I'm Goodness. I made this course for kids 7–16..."*

Step 4 — Post for free, this week (all from your phone)

- **Mumsnet (UK)** → Education / Tech Talk forum — ONE honest post explaining what you built and why. UK parents trust Mumsnet. Don't spam.
- **Facebook groups** — search "homeschool UK", "homeschool moms", "screen-free parenting", "Python parents". Join 5. Post your 30-sec video. **Link the free Lessons 0+1, not the buy page** — trust first.
- **Reddit** — r/HomeschoolRecovery, r/homeschool, r/learnpython. Be careful — Reddit hates ads.
- **TikTok / Instagram Reels** — post the 15-second cut daily for 2 weeks. Hashtags: `#kidscoding` `#pythonforkids` `#homeschoolmom` `#stem`
- **WhatsApp** — your own network. Post in 2–3 parent groups you're already in. The first 5 sales almost always come from people who know you.

4. ■ Marketing (continued)

Step 5 — Paid ads (after free wins, week 3+)

Use **Meta Ads Manager** (Facebook + Instagram) from the phone. Spend **£5/day for 7 days = £35 total**. Target: UK parents of 7–14-year-olds interested in homeschool, coding, STEM. Send them to your free Lessons 0+1 page. Track conversions in Gumroad.

Avoid Google Ads until later — keyword bidding is more skill-intensive and easier to burn cash on.

Step 6 — Phone tooling stack

Need	Tool	Free?
Video edits	CapCut	Free
Ad copy & social posts	Claude on mobile (you're using it)	Free with usage limit
Image creation	Canva mobile	Free tier is plenty
Email collection	Mailerlite mobile	Free up to 1000 subscribers
Schedule posts	Buffer or Later	Free for 3 channels
Quick analytics	Gumroad mobile	Built-in
Customer email	Gmail (alias already wired)	Free

You can run the entire business from one phone. Many indie creators do.

Step 7 — Email-then-sell loop

When someone tries Lessons 0+1, capture their email at the bottom of Lesson 1 ("Want me to send Lesson 2 when it's ready? Drop your email"). Use Mailerlite. After 2 days, send: *"How was Lesson 1? Here's a 20% launch discount for the rest."* That single sequence converts ~10–15% of free users into paying ones.

I can add the email-capture form to Lesson 1 whenever you want — just say the word.

5. ■■ Legal Pages: Is It Compulsory?

Yes, for UK sales — and especially because you're selling to / about children. Three specific pages you must have:

- 1 **Privacy Policy** — required under **UK GDPR / Data Protection Act 2018** the moment you collect ANY personal data (email addresses count). Must say what you collect, why, how long you keep it, who you share it with.
- 2 **Terms of Service** — required to enforce things like "no refunds after 14 days" or "don't share your password publicly." Without ToS, courts default to most consumer-friendly reading.
- 3 **Refund Policy** — required under the **Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013**. Digital products have a **14-day right to cancel** unless the customer agrees to waive it (which is standard for "instant access" courses).

A **cookie banner** is required if you're using cookies — localStorage is borderline. Safer to add one.

Cheapest path (£0–£15)

- **Termly.io** — free tier generates Privacy Policy + ToS + Cookie Policy via a 10-minute questionnaire. Outputs live URLs.
- Add three links to your footer: Privacy · Terms · Refund Policy
- Add the small cookie banner script Termly also provides (free).

One UK-specific note: because your course is for children and you're collecting parent emails (not kid data directly), you're in a safer GDPR position. **Don't collect anything from the child** beyond what's stored in localStorage on their own device. As long as the buying PARENT is the one giving an email and consenting, you're fine.

Do Termly today. Add the three footer links. You're legally clean to sell to UK + EU + US customers. Total cost: free.

6. ■ Weekend Launch Punch List

Two focused hours, zero coding, and you have a live business. Tick each box:

■	Record the showcase gameplay video	15 min
■	Termly Privacy + Terms + Refund + cookie banner	10 min
■	Make a 1200x630 social-share image in Canva	5 min
■	Add a favicon (Canva can generate)	5 min
■	Add <meta og:image> to index.html (Claude can do this)	2 min
■	Create Gumroad product with live Vercel URL + password in post-purchase message	10 min
■	Replace gumroad.com placeholder on landing page with real Gumroad URL	2 min
■	Post the 15-sec demo to TikTok + Facebook + WhatsApp	15 min
■	Post one heartfelt thread to Mumsnet Education forum	10 min
■	Email 5 friends with kids — "made this, would love a thought"	10 min

One last thing. The first 10 sales are the hardest. The next 100 come from people the first 10 told. So when those first kids finish the course, ASK them to record a 10-second playing-their-game video and let you share it. That's how solo creators go from "a few sales" to "a real business."